



247–c. 183 BCE
HANNIBAL

Hannibal was a respected military tactician who led the Carthaginian forces against Rome in the Second Punic War. After the war, he served as a reforming statesman.

“I will either find a way, or make one.”
(*“Aut viam inveniam aut faciam.”*)

LATIN PROVERB, COMMONLY ATTRIBUTED TO HANNIBAL

▽ Death of Archimedes, mosaic



213–212 BCE

SIEGE OF SYRACUSE

At the height of the Second Punic War (218–201 BCE), the Romans laid siege to the strategically important city of Syracuse in Sicily, then an independent kingdom. In the aftermath, Archimedes, whose ingenious inventions had helped to defend Syracuse, was mistakenly killed by a Roman soldier.

221 BCE The Warring States Period comes to an end after Zheng, King of Qin, unites the kingdoms of China into a single empire

206 BCE The fall of the short-lived Qin dynasty marks the beginning of civil war in China as the Chu and Han kingdoms vie for control

201 BCE

218 BCE Carthaginian general Hannibal crosses the Alps with his army and 37 elephants, and defeats the Romans at the Battle of Cannae



△ Battle of Cape Ecnomus



202 BCE

THE HAN DYNASTY

Discontent with the strict legalist rule of China's Qin dynasty ultimately led to its downfall and four years of conflict, centred around the so-called Chu-Han Contention. The Han dynasty emerged as the victors, and united the empire: they would remain in power for centuries.

△ Bronze horse of the Han Dynasty